

1 Processor:

Intel Core i7 - 4960x:

When you're trying to build the fastest PC, you can't discount the fastest enthusiast grade CPU in the world, the 4960x. After all, you need the fastest CPU for the fastest PC and we would have settled for nothing less. With over 1.86 billion transistors on a die that's merely 257mm, the 4960x packs a big punch and add the words "fully unlocked" to it and you'll find overclocking enthusiasts drooling all over themselves.

The 4960x was the only 6-core, hyper-threaded CPU available that could give us serious results, be it for multi-core video rendering or for other CPU intensive number crunching tasks. Using this Ivy Bridge - E chip also meant that we'll have an updated memory controller which is rated for 1866 MHz natively, as opposed to the 1600 MHz seen earlier. As for future proofing, it provides official compliance with PCI Express 3.0 with 40 whole lanes of PCIe connectivity.

This wonderful piece of silicon is unlocked, presenting a total of 63x multipliers which would let anyone easily push memory data rates past the 2400 MHz mark. This PC is so powerful that it took our rig to the top 100 list in 3DMark's Hall of Fame without even minor over-clocking. Quite a feat.



3 Graphics Cards:

NVIDIA GeForce GTX 780Ti in Quad SLI

Have you heard the saying: "A good graphics card maketh a good gaming system"? Well we have, and it seems we've heard it enough times to change it into: "four good graphics cards maketh an awesome system". More is always better (probably) and in this case we couldn't leave out the best performing single GPU card on the planet and that's why four of these power hungry silicon beasts were chosen, and also because it would be blasphemy to leave a slot empty on the Rampage IV. Together these cards have a total of 11,520 Stream processors and 12GB of Video memory, with the overall transistor count going beyond 24 Billion; boy that's a lot.

Benchmarking these cards was the most wonderful experience ever considering they toppled every other score that we had previously recorded. This was the only time when we saw the 3D Mark Fire Strike FPS in triple digits. We also used a triple monitor setup to run benchmarks at 5760x1080 resolutions at full settings. Tests like Unigine Heaven gave us 115FPS for 1080p and 40FPS for triple monitor tests. Cinebench R15 was another testament to the power of this machine with it getting 110.24 FPS in an OpenGL benchmark run. When the numbers started pouring in like rain in the monsoon, that's the time we realised the sheer luxury of having this much power at our disposal.



2 Motherboard:

ASUS Rampage IV Black Edition

With the responsibility of fitting and managing so many expensive components on its shoulders, we need a motherboard that was exceptional, a board befitting a king. The Rampage IV Black Edition from ASUS was the only one that fit the bill. The board itself is awesome, but the OC panel even better. ASUS took all the standard overclocking options and put them into a separate panel that can be affixed to the front of the panel. This allows for on-the-fly overclocking with no need to enter the BIOS and incorporates features like an OC Key, VGA hotwire and an LN2 switch.

The board is an all-black affair and understated enough for our more refined sensibilities (yes, we consider ourselves to be that refined). Of course, we didn't select this board for its looks, we chose it for its Quad SLI and Crossfire-X support, exceptional power management, support for 8-PWM fans and support for RAMDisks and 2800MHz RAM. Oh, and the audio chipset on this is quite exceptional as well, saving us from the trouble of adding on a separate sound card. This truly is an exceptional board for an exceptional PC.

4 RAM:

Corsair Dominator Platinum 32GB 2133Mhz

32GB? Yes, you read that right, we had to settle for "only" 32GB of RAM. Not out of choice mind you, there wasn't a single 64GB kit available in the country at the time we assembled this rig. Of course, no application really uses that much RAM, but who cares about the real world right? Corsair's Dominator series of memory have developed a great reputation for their performance. Passmark for instance gave a score of 3074 in its Memory Mark tests which is nothing short of breath-taking. In all the time we were using this PC, the maximum RAM ever consumed even under taxing situations was under 7GB. Well that's a lot of memory to spare. But wait! What about a RAMDisk? We have memory to spare right?

